

CSS 385 A: Introduction to Game Development

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- [Homepage](#) || [Research Group](#) || [All Course Evaluations](#) || [RateMyProfessors](#)
- **Office hours:** Monday 12:15-1:15pm, Wednesday 5:30-6:30pm @ UW1-260Q - signup via Canvas Calendar
- **Class Sessions:** 3:30-5:30pm MW at UW1-202
- [Course website](#)
- **Class Discord:** <https://discord.gg/5mEm92e>
- You can submit [anonymous feedback](#) for this class anytime during the quarter

Course Description

Examines the fundamental issues in designing and developing computer video games; creative and artistic elements, story narration, software architecture, interaction model, mathematic, physics, special effects, and in-game AI logic. Experiences elements in game design: world setting, game play, and interface; and experiences implementing games: conceptualization, prototyping, and play testing. Prerequisite: STMATH 125 or MATH 125; and CSS 340 or CSS 342.

Learning Objectives

- Critically examine video games
- Understand the structure of games
- Design, prototype, test and implement a game from scratch
- Understand and extend techniques commonly used in games
- Work in groups, present and reflect on extended project

Textbooks

- None - Readings will be provided

Grading

Required

- Final group project (0.5 points)

Optional

- Up to 5 individual projects (0.5 points each, max 2.5)
- 2-person project (0.5 points)
- Game mechanic writeup with code and video (0.5 points)

To get 2.0, you can

- Complete the Final group project and 3 individual projects, OR
- Complete the Final group project, 1 individual project, the 2-person project and the game mechanic writeup

To get 4.0, you need to

- Complete the Final group project, 5 individual projects, the 2-person project and the game mechanic writeup

Rules for Deliverables

- Each deliverable is marked as accepted/not accepted. If it is not accepted, you have one week to revise and resubmit it. If it gets "not accepted" a second time, you cannot count that project towards the course grade.
- If your project is very similar to a previous project and does not demonstrate learning new concepts, it will be graded as "not accepted"
- The "Final" has to be delivered at the end of Week-10.

- The final has additional sub-deliverables: digital prototype-1 (week 6), digital prototype-2 (week 7), alpha testing (week 8) and beta testing (week 9)
- You cannot deliver more than one project per week
- If you are going to submit 6 projects, the 2-person project and the game mechanic writeup that means you have to essentially turn in a new project each week
- If you are doing 3 projects, you can turn them in as late as week-7, week-8 and week-9
- All deliverables are due by Sunday midnight via Canvas.

See [Projects - FAQ](#) for details of the projects.

Final Project

To be completed in groups of 3-4 people. More details on the assignment page.

Policies

You get to decide how many projects you are going to complete and the schedule you are going to deliver them. You are in charge of your learning.

See the [https://bit.ly/STEMClassroom Policies](https://bit.ly/STEMClassroom_Policies) which covers:

- Academic Integrity
- Access and Accommodations
- Classroom Emergency Preparedness
- For Our Veterans
- Grade of Incomplete
- Inclement Weather
- Parenting Resources
- Religious Accommodations

- Respect for Diversity
- Student Support Services
- Surviving Sexual and Relationship Violence
- Wonder How to Address Faculty?

The UW Religious Accommodations Policy can be found at
<https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy/>